

Build Audit-Ready Client Files

Make the file explain what happened and why.

MISSION BRIEF

Organize source documents, questionnaires, notes, calculations, review evidence, signatures, and retention controls into one defensible record.

FOUR OPERATING PRINCIPLES

Identity Client authorization, identity, and engagement records	Evidence Source documents, questionnaires, and calculations
Reasoning Follow-up inquiries, notes, exceptions, and conclusions	Control Review, signatures, retention, access, and final archive

TOOLKIT SOURCE: PAGE 65

Verify current requirements with official sources and qualified professionals.

Client File Architecture

Assess the four layers that make a file retrievable and defensible.

Identity

Client authorization, identity, and engagement records

Evidence

Source documents, questionnaires, and calculations

Reasoning

Follow-up inquiries, notes, exceptions, and conclusions

Control

Review, signatures, retention, access, and final archive

Accountable owner

Name the role responsible for completion

Completion evidence

Record the document, test, approval, or proof

Describe the naming and folder rule that will let another authorized reviewer understand a file without asking the preparer.

Use this page to prepare focused questions for the appropriate government agency, attorney, tax professional, banker, insurer, technology professional, or vendor.

1. QUESTION / ITEM TO VERIFY

2. QUESTION / ITEM TO VERIFY

3. QUESTION / ITEM TO VERIFY

4. QUESTION / ITEM TO VERIFY

READY CHECK	STATUS
Source requirements verified	[]
Action-plan facts documented	[]
Professional questions prepared	[]
Source documents stored securely	[]
Next owner and due date assigned	[]

Do not place Social Security numbers, client return information, account credentials, or other sensitive identifiers in this worksheet.